

Automation Potential Grid

SLIBRARY 06 · SHEET 3 / 5

Task automatability vs. value

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Automation Potential Grid plots tasks by how automatable they are against how much value automating them would create, to prioritise where AI automation should be applied first.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Grounded in the task-based automation research of Frey and Osborne and of Brynjolfsson, Mitchell and Rock on suitability for machine learning.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to move automation decisions from the whole-job level to the task level, where the real opportunity and risk lie.

FIGURE 1 · AUTOMATION POTENTIAL GRID

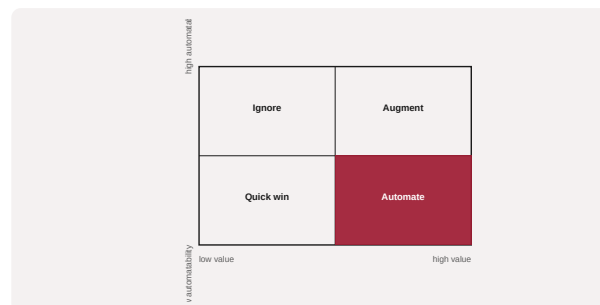


Figure 1. A schematic of the Automation Potential Grid as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Tasks are scored on automatability and value; high-value, highly automatable tasks are prioritised, while high-value, low-automatability tasks are targeted for augmentation.

WHEN IT IS USED

During workforce and process redesign and AI use-case selection.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Operations leaders, process owners and workforce planners.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It reframes automation around tasks rather than jobs, aligning with evidence that AI augments far more tasks than it fully automates.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Value-Chain Heatmap · Slibrary 6

Function Benefit Matrix · Slibrary 6

AI Use-Case Portfolio · Slibrary 6

Capability Uplift Map · Slibrary 6

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Brynjolfsson, E., Mitchell, T. and Rock, D. (2018) 'What can machines learn and what does it mean for occupations?', AEA Papers and Proceedings, 108.

Frey, C.B. and Osborne, M.A. (2017) 'The future of employment', Technological Forecasting and Social Change, 114.